

Savings Tracker

Spreadsheet Documentation

MoneyMingle Project

August 2026

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Overview

The Savings Tracker is a Google Sheets workbook built to monitor financial goals, track account balances, and log deposits, withdrawals, and reallocations. It gives a clear visual read on financial progress and automates the arithmetic behind reaching each target.

This document describes how the spreadsheet is structured and how its automations work. It also serves as the functional specification for **MoneyMingle**, the web application being built to replace it.

This spreadsheet and its original documentation were developed with assistance from Google Gemini, and reformatted here for the MoneyMingle project.

Key Features

- **Multi-Goal Tracking** — Monitor several distinct savings goals simultaneously (e.g. Emergency Fund, Vacation, Home).
- **Multi-Account Management** — Track balances across multiple accounts or wallets (e.g. a credit card, a cash wallet).
- **Automated Progress Metrics** — Instantly view percentage completed, amount remaining, and the monthly contribution needed to hit each deadline.
- **Visual Dashboard** — A stacked bar chart and in-cell progress bars give a quick visual health check of overall finances.
- **One-Click Automations** — Macro buttons log allocations and reallocate funds between goals without manual row editing.

Spreadsheet Sections

The workbook is organized into four functional areas. Everything in the first two sections is *derived* — none of it is typed in directly; it's calculated from the Transaction Log described in the third section.

A. Savings Goal Tracker (the dashboard)

Column	What it holds
Goal Name & Target Amount	The objective and the total amount needed.
Saved So Far & Remaining	Calculated current dedicated funds, and what's left to save.
% Complete & Progress Bar	A percentage plus an in-cell visual bar that fills as the goal nears completion.
Target Date & Months Left	The deadline and how much time remains.
Monthly Target	The monthly contribution required to hit the target date.
Accomplished	A manual checkbox marking a goal as fully funded.

B. Account Summary

Tracks the physical locations money actually sits in, following a “zero-based” approach where every dollar is assigned to a goal.

Column	What it holds
Previous Balance	The starting balance for the account.
Current Balance	Live balance, updated automatically from logged transactions.
Status	Whether the account's balance is fully allocated to goals or not.
Money Left to Allocate	Any balance not yet assigned to a specific goal.

C. Transaction Log

The central engine — every dashboard and account number is pulled from this log via formula, never entered by hand elsewhere.

Column	What it holds
Date	When the transaction occurred.
Goal	Which goal the transaction applies to.
Description	A short free-text note.
Account	Which account the money moved through.
Amount	The dollar amount.
Transaction Type	Deposit or Withdrawal.

D. Visual Charts

Savings Allocation by Account and Goal — a stacked column chart showing exactly how much of each account's balance is dedicated to each goal, at a glance.

Example Data (Illustrative)

The table below shows the *shape* of the data with placeholder figures — not real account information — to illustrate how a populated goal tracker looks.

Goal	Target	Saved So Far	Remaining	% Complete	Target Date
Emergency Fund	\$10,000	\$5,400	\$4,600	54%	Dec 2026
Vacation	\$2,000	\$1,100	\$900	55%	Dec 2026
Home Down Payment	\$500	\$500	\$0	100%	Aug 2026

How Calculations Work

Metric	Calculation Method
Saved So Far	SUMIFS totals all Deposits and subtracts Withdrawals tied to a specific Goal Name.
Current Balance (Accounts)	Previous Balance adjusted by the sum of all transactions linked to that Account Name.
Monthly Target	$(\text{Target Amount} - \text{Saved So Far}) \div \text{Months Left}$.

Metric	Calculation Method
Cross-Referencing Matrix	A hidden background matrix computes what proportion of each account's balance belongs to each goal — this powers the stacked chart.

Automations (Google Apps Script)

Two macro buttons drive data entry so the Transaction Log stays consistent:

- **Log Allocation** — captures data from a staging area and appends it as a new permanent row in the Transaction Log.
- **Log Reallocation** — moves funds between goals or accounts by automatically generating a *balanced pair* of rows: a withdrawal from the source and a deposit to the destination.

Step-by-Step: Using the Tracker

1. **Set up a goal** — enter the Goal Name, Target Amount, and Target Date. The monthly target computes instantly.
2. **Set starting balances** — enter each account's Previous Balance in the Account Summary section.
3. **Log a transaction** — add a row to the Transaction Log with Date, Goal, Account, Amount, and Type. The dashboard updates immediately.
4. **Reallocate funds** — use the reallocation tool and the Log Reallocation button to move money between goals without breaking the underlying math.

Appendix: Mapping to the MoneyMingle Data Model

The web app replaces spreadsheet rows and formulas with database tables and queries. Each spreadsheet concept has a direct counterpart:

Spreadsheet	MoneyMingle
A row in the Transaction Log	A row in the Transaction table (date, goal_id, account_id, amount, type, description)
A row in the Savings Goal Tracker	A row in the Goal table (name, target_amount, target_date, accomplished)
A row in the Account Summary	A row in the Account table (name, previous_balance)
“Saved So Far” formula	A SUM query over Transaction filtered by goal_id
“Current Balance” formula	previous_balance + SUM of Transaction filtered by account_id
Log Reallocation macro	Application code that inserts a linked withdrawal + deposit transaction pair in one action

See [docs/initial-thoughts.md](#) for the full data model discussion.